

LIWELILE IMPUMELELO COMMUNITY CENTRE

Programme 1: Elderly Feeding & Wellness –

Kitchen Safety Protocol



NPO 167-542 | PBO 930052254

22 Fox Glove Avenue, Primrose, Germiston

Purpose

This protocol ensures the safety of staff, volunteers, and beneficiaries by preventing accidents and maintaining a hygienic, well-organised kitchen environment.

General Safety Rules

Rule	Explanation
No running in the kitchen	Prevents slips, falls, and collisions
Closed, non-slip shoes must be worn	Protects feet from spills and dropped items
Aprons and hairnets are mandatory	Maintains personal hygiene and food safety
Hands must be washed before food handling	Prevents contamination
Report any injuries immediately	Ensures prompt first aid and documentation
Keep work surfaces clear	Reduces risk of cuts, burns, and contamination

Equipment Handling

Equipment	Safe Practice
Knives	Use cutting boards; carry with blade down; store separately
Hot surfaces / pots	Use oven mitts; turn handles inward; warn others when moving
Gas stove	Check connections; never leave open flame unattended
Electrical appliances	Keep cords away from water; unplug when not in use; report frayed cords

Cans / lids	Dispose of sharp lids immediately; use can opener correctly
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Fire Safety

- Fire extinguisher located near kitchen exit – check pressure gauge monthly.
- Fire blanket mounted on wall – used for small grease fires or clothing fires.
- In case of fire:
 1. Shout “FIRE!” to alert others.
 2. If small and contained, use extinguisher (PASS: Pull, Aim, Squeeze, Sweep) or blanket.
 3. If not quickly controlled, evacuate kitchen and call 10177.

Never pour water on a grease fire.

Food Safety

Practice	Why
Wash all produce before use	Removes dirt and contaminants
Separate raw and cooked foods	Prevents cross-contamination
Cook foods to safe temperatures	Kills harmful bacteria (min 75°C for poultry, 70°C for others)
Refrigerate perishables below 5°C	Slows bacterial growth
Check expiry dates	Discard expired items immediately
Cool leftovers quickly before storing	Avoids bacterial growth in the “danger zone” (5°C–60°C)

Cleaning & Sanitisation

Surfaces: Clean with hot, soapy water after each use; sanitise with approved solution.

Utensils: Wash in hot, soapy water; rinse; air dry or use dishwasher.

Floors: Sweep after each meal; mop daily with disinfectant.

Waste: Dispose of food waste promptly; keep bins covered.

First Aid in the Kitchen

First aid kit located on the wall near the exit.

Burns: Cool under running water for 10 minutes; do not apply ice or butter. Cover with clean, dry dressing.

Cuts: Clean with water; apply pressure; cover with sterile bandage.

Allergic reaction: If severe, call ambulance immediately (084 124 or 082 911).

Kitchen Staff Responsibilities

Staff	Responsibility
Kitchen Supervisor	Enforce safety protocols; conduct daily safety checks; report hazards
Cooks	Follow safe handling practices; keep workstations clean; report injuries
Volunteers	Ask before using unfamiliar equipment; follow instructions; keep work areas tidy

Daily Safety Checklist (to be completed by Kitchen Supervisor)

Item	Checked (✓)
Fire extinguisher in place, pressure OK	☐ Yes
Fire blanket accessible	☐ Yes
No slip/trip hazards on floor	☐ Yes
All electrical cords in good condition	☐ Yes
Gas connections secure	☐ Yes
First aid kit stocked	☐ Yes
Refrigerator temperature $\leq 5^{\circ}\text{C}$	☐ Yes
All food within expiry dates	☐ Yes

Date: _____ Supervisor: _____